



India gets its first 3G tablet



Olive Telecom has launched the OlivePad - VT100, claiming it as India's first 3.5G tablet PC. The OlivePad runs on Google's Android operating system and supports 3.5G networks, Wi-Fi and Bluetooth.

With an inbuilt three megapixel camera and a front camera, the OlivePad can also be used as video-calling equipment. Sporting a touchscreen, it allows you to access the Web, do instant messaging, use multimedia, and work in the world of social networking. It also features GPS for maps, a gaming console, an e-book reader, TV, flash support, mini USB port and dual cameras (a 3-megapixel rear camera and a VGA front camera).

Above all, it can work as your smartphone, allowing you to make voice and video calls.

Priced at Rs 25,000, the OlivePad will be available across the country at all Croma stores from this August. More at: <http://bit.ly/Olivepad>

Here comes India's first Web browser



Hidden Reflex, an Indian start-up, has rolled out the first Web browser for India. Based on the open source Mozilla platform, the new browser, 'Epic', comes with a host of features and claims to be easy to use.

India is the primary focus of the browser; its India sidebar supports Indian content by providing users access to the latest national and regional news from popular publications, live television channels, videos, stock quotes, live cricket scores, top music albums and local events. It currently supports 12 Indian languages. To allow safe browsing, it comes with an in-built anti-virus solution, warning you when you're at a website loaded with viruses and spyware.

Epic claims to be the first browser to include a suite of productivity applications, including a free word processor, video sidebar (picture-in-picture functionality), communication apps like Facebook and Twitter, the My Computer file browser, and over 1500 free, user-installable sidebar apps in the Epic Apps Store.

Tamil Nadu government vouches for Unicode

The Tamil Nadu government issued an order on June 23, 2010, that it will migrate from 8-bit encoding to 16-bit encoding (mainly Unicode), for all its computer applications in Tamil. Unicode will mainly be used in all applications where support for Tamil is available. And for applications that do not support Unicode, TACE16 (Tamil All Character Encoding) will be used as the alternative standard. More at: <http://bit.ly/tn-gov-in>



Firefox doubles up as IBM's default browser

IBM has embraced the most used open source browser, Firefox, and made it the company's default browser. "We're officially adding a new piece of software to the list of default common applications we expect employees to use, and that's the Mozilla Firefox browser," blogs IBM executive Bob Sutor. "So what does it mean for Firefox to be the default browser inside IBM? Those employees who are currently not using Firefox will be strongly encouraged to use it as their default browser. All new computers will be provisioned with it. We will continue to strongly encourage our vendors who have browser-based software to fully support Firefox," blogs Sutor.

More at: <http://bit.ly/bob-sutor>

Android 3.0 to be shipped in October

Code-named 'Gingerbread', the third version of Google's Android mobile operating system is likely to be released in mid-October. The new version will require a 1 GHz processor, an 8.9 cm (3.5 inch) display and 512 MB of RAM. But devices that don't meet the hardware requirements will have to stay with its predecessor versions. The latest release of Android is version 2.2, code-named 'Froyo', released at this year's Google I/O developer conference. So far, the only device to be officially updated to Android 2.2 is Google's Nexus One smartphone. More at: <http://bit.ly/Android3>